



Outlook

[EXTERNAL] Raw Notes and artifacts from AI Workshop: Analysis of Case Studies; Identified Use Cases; Vision Statements

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Zach, Scott,

Analysis of use Cases:

Key Strengths Identified:

- **Ethics & Philosophy:** Explicit integration in AI plans.
- **Human-Centered Approach:** Focus on augmentation, not replacement.
- **Comprehensive Planning:** Infrastructure, governance, and readiness plans established before implementation.
- **AI Literacy:** Required for all stakeholders (students, faculty, staff).
- **Curricular Integration:** AI embedded across curricula, with real-world applications and client engagement.
- **Transparency & Accountability:** Emphasis on governance, public transparency, and responsible use.
- **Security & Privacy:** Specific attention to AI security and privacy standards.
- **Human Oversight:** Ensuring human involvement in AI processes.
- **Outcome Focus:** Identification and measurement of outcomes.
- **Clear Timelines:** Use of roadmaps for implementation.

Key Weaknesses/Gaps Identified:

- **Cost Efficiency:** Noted as a possible weakness.
- **Incident Response:** Lack of protocols in some plans.
- **Faculty Trust:** Gaps in trust and premature use of AI in courses.
- **Implementation Gaps:** Need for improvement in faculty training, business/administrative adoption, and scaling efforts.
- **Experimental Phase:** Thin evidence and early-stage experimentation in some areas.
- **Governance Needs:** Need to strengthen governance structures.
- **Outcome Clarity:** Need to clearly identify and measure outcomes.
- **Ambitious Scope:** Large-scale transformation and reinvention may present execution and scaling challenges.

Summary Statement:

The addition of the AI Strategy Scorecard reinforces the importance of governance, literacy, security, privacy, and human oversight in AI initiatives. Across all notes, there is a consistent emphasis on ethical, responsible, and human-centered AI integration, with robust planning and accountability. Weaknesses and gaps continue to center on implementation, governance, and clarity of outcomes, as well as challenges in scaling and building trust.

Certainly! Here is a table summarizing the extracted points, strengths, and weaknesses/gaps from all the photos:

Theme/Area	Key Points / Practices	Strengths	Weaknesses / Gaps
Ethics & Philosophy	Explicit integration of philosophy and ethics; responsible, human oversight	Ethical foundation; human-centered approach	—
Governance & Planning	AI governance boards, clear roadmaps, public transparency, central coordination, outcome scorecards	Strong governance structures; clear timelines and accountability	Need to strengthen governance; outcome clarity
AI Literacy & Training	AI literacy required for all (students, faculty, staff); faculty learning academies	Broad AI literacy; training resources	Faculty trust issues; need for improved and scaled training
Curriculum Integration	Embedding AI across curriculum; real-world, client-focused projects; soft skills	Comprehensive curricular integration; practical experience	Premature use of AI in courses; experimental phase
Infrastructure	Infrastructure set up before implementation; includes all students	Inclusive, well-planned infrastructure	—
Transparency & Accountability	Public transparency in funding, strategy, and policies; human accountability (“human in the loop”)	Transparent, responsible use of AI	—
Security & Privacy	AI security/privacy standards established	Focus on data protection and privacy	—
Outcome Focus	Identification and measurement of outcomes; weighted criteria for strategy	Clear focus on results and continuous improvement	Need to clarify and measure outcomes

Business/ Admin Implementation	Embedding AI into administrative workflows (training, experimentation, ROI monitoring)	Administrative efficiency and innovation	Lacking implementation in business/admin; scaling challenges
Cost & Efficiency	Cost efficiency discussed as a possible issue	Awareness of financial implications	Cost efficiency as a possible weakness
Incident Response	Mention of lack of incident & response protocol	—	Need for incident/response protocols
Opportunities & Vision	Major opportunities for student success, workforce readiness, research, operations, excellence, and productivity	Clear vision tied to outcomes and mission	—
Ambitious Scope	“Total reinvention”; large-scale transformation	Ambitious, future-oriented plans	Execution and scaling challenges

Legend:

— = No explicit weakness/gap identified in that area

If you'd like this in a different format (e.g., by institution or with more detail), let me know!

AI Use Cases and Strategic Focus Areas (Summary)

1. Practical AI Use Cases

- **Gap Analysis:** Identify potential weaknesses and security issues.
- **Alumni Engagement:** Connect and predict alumni involvement; build a sense of belonging with students.
- **Learning Augmentation:** Enhance learning for individuals and groups (e.g., "teach me ____").
- **Predictions & Planning:** Forecast student enrollments, plan course sections, and faculty/staff hiring.
- **Research & Grant Writing:** Use AI agents for research and grant writing.
- **Grant Administration:** Manage bureaucracy and compliance for grants.
- **Collaboration:** Enable cross-divisional collaborations, find synergies, and identify collaborators.
- **Instructional Coaching & Student Success:** Detect student inactivity/disengagement, generate reports, and flag faculty.
- **Employee Productivity:** Improve productivity and manage redundancy.
- **Communication Tool:** Enhance communication within the organization.
- **Capacity Building:** Support capacity building and redundancy.
- **Visa Process:** Streamline visa processes for employees and students.
- **Fundraising & Promotion:** Identify opportunities for fundraising and promotion.
- **Recruiting:** Integrate AI to assist in recruiting efforts.
- **Decision Support:** Improve productivity and enhance decision support (financial and pedagogical).
- **Career Readiness:** Prepare AI career-ready students and define what "AI core" means.

2. Strategic Focus Areas for AI

- **AI Governance & Infrastructure:**
 - Establish foundational governance and strategic documents.
 - Accelerate initiatives with strategic planning.

- Ensure ethical and acceptable use in common language.
- Focus on ethics and governance.
- **AI Literacy through Curriculum:**
 - Distribute AI literacy across curriculum with external advisory boards.
 - Establish university-wide and discipline-specific competencies.
 - Integrate AI across all curriculum areas.
- **Faculty Development & Buy-In:**
 - Inform and shape faculty involvement and implementation.
- **Centralized AI Support:** Provide a centralized support system for AI initiatives.

3. AI Competitive “Flywheel” (Key Elements)

- **AI Literate Curriculum:** Supports student success.
- **Governance & Data Readiness:** Prepares workforce readiness.
- **Secure Platforms:** Enhances research capacity.
- **Responsible Innovation:** Drives operational efficiency.
- These elements are interconnected and create a cycle for ongoing improvement and competitiveness.

4. Overarching Goals and Needs

- **Employ AI to Graduation:** Extend AI use to support student progression and graduation.
- **Efficiency in Administration:** Use AI to optimize and streamline administrative processes.
- **Teaching & Learning:** Transform and enhance teaching and learning experiences with AI.
- **Training & Literacy:** Provide widespread AI training and literacy.
- **Human Capital Investment:** Invest in AI engineering and expertise (“we need NERDS”).
- **Microcredentialing:** Offer microcredentials in AI.
- **Embed AI in Curriculum:** Integrate AI education throughout the curriculum.

5. Vision & Strategic Leadership in AI

- **Leaders Should Know:**
 - AI is rapidly changing; assumptions are being made.
 - AI literacy is essential for leaders.
 - Heavy AI agent employment may reduce visibility of actions taken by AI.
 - AI should be used in strategic communications.
 - Leaders should stay aware of trends outside their own sector.
 - There are unanticipated costs in AI investment.
 - Avoid investing in a single AI solution, as the industry is still evolving.
 - Be aware, act, and understand the broader context of AI deployment.

Overall:

The collection of notes and diagrams outlines a holistic vision for AI in education and organizational contexts. It emphasizes practical applications (planning, engagement, productivity, fundraising, recruiting), strategic infrastructure (governance, curriculum, centralized support, faculty development), a cyclical model for competitive advantage (the “AI Competitive Flywheel”), and the importance of visionary leadership. Key needs include training, human capital investment, embedding AI into all aspects of the educational experience, maintaining a strong focus on ethics and governance, and strategic leadership that is adaptable, informed, and cautious in a rapidly evolving field.

Tarleton needs to prioritize use cases: Putting these use cases into an AI model to prioritize them, my results show:

1. AI Literacy Across the Curriculum

Why prioritized:

Universities are increasingly embedding AI education into general curricula, not just computer science or engineering. This ensures all students, regardless of major, gain foundational AI knowledge and skills. Institutions like MIT, Stanford, and Georgia Tech have launched interdisciplinary AI literacy initiatives, recognizing that AI impacts every field.

Key Activities:

- Developing university-wide and discipline-specific AI competencies.
- Offering AI microcredentials and certificates.
- Integrating AI concepts into existing courses across disciplines.

2. Operational Efficiency and Decision Support

Why prioritized:

AI is widely adopted for improving administrative efficiency and supporting data-driven decision-making. Schools use AI for enrollment predictions, course scheduling, resource allocation, and even financial planning. This helps universities optimize resources, improve student outcomes, and reduce costs.

Key Activities:

- Predicting student enrollments and optimizing course sections.
- Enhancing productivity and administrative decision support.
- Employing AI for grant administration and compliance.

3. Student Success and Retention

Why prioritized:

AI-powered tools are being used to monitor student engagement, predict at-risk students, and personalize learning pathways. Many universities have implemented AI-driven advising systems and early alert systems to improve retention and graduation rates.

Key Activities:

- Using AI to detect student inactivity/disengagement and flag faculty.
- Personalized learning and instructional coaching.
- AI-driven student support and communication tools.

Summary Table:

Priority	Use Case	Why It's a Top Priority
1	AI Literacy Across the Curriculum	Ensures all students are AI-ready for the workforce
2	Operational Efficiency & Decision Support	Optimizes resources and administrative processes
3	Student Success and Retention	Boosts retention and academic outcomes with AI insights

Note:

While other areas like research, fundraising, and faculty development are important, these top three reflect the most widespread, impactful, and scalable trends in US higher education AI integration as of 2024.

Vision Statements:

Tarleton State will thoughtfully integrate AI across learning, work, and institutional operations to improve student success and create lasting value for all stakeholders.

Tarleton State University will leverage AI to accelerate degree completion, streamline university operations, and ensure academic integrity through innovation that prepares students for life-long learning in an AI world

Tarleton State University will harness A.I. to enhance student success, accelerate innovation and empower our stakeholders to thrive in a rapidly evolving world. Through responsible and ethical use, we will amplify human potential, transform lives and inspire future generations to lead, innovate and create lasting value for society.

"Tarleton State will use AI technology to transform learning, research, institutional effectiveness, and operational efficiency while preparing every student for an AI-enabled future and maintaining the highest standards of integrity, privacy, and trust."

We will use AI to improve student success, workforce readiness, academic excellence, research innovation, operational effectiveness, and community impact while protecting academic integrity, privacy, security, access, and human judgement.

Vision Statement

"Tarleton State University will responsibly use AI to prepare every learner and colleague for an AI-enabled future while strengthening student success, trusted data use, institutional effectiveness, and workforce impact."

Tarleton State University will harness responsible, human-centered, AI to advance research excellence, improve student success, strengthened workforce readiness, and create transformational impact for Texas and beyond!

PILLARS

Research Excellence

Student Retention + Success

Academic Innovation + AI Literacy

Workforce + Economic Impact

Operational Excellence

Responsible AI Governance

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